

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
RUMOMASI**

TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: SEVEN

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Comprehension Skills

Introduction

- Comprehension is reading with understanding. The skills needed are skimming (reading quickly for the gist), scanning (looking for specific information), reading for the main idea, and reading for the writer's purpose and tone.

Reading strategies

- Preview the title and the first sentences; predict what the passage is about; read the passage through; re-read with the questions in mind; underline key sentences; answer in your own words in complete sentences; and give the required number of points.

Tips for answers

- Identify the topic sentence; note the supporting details (examples, figures, contrast); infer meanings of words from context; and match the marks to the number of points (a 4-mark question needs four points).

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define skimming and scanning.
2. What is the main idea of a passage?
3. How do you work out the meaning of an unfamiliar word?
4. Why must answers be in the candidate's own words?

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: EIGHT

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Letter Writing Basics (Formal & Informal)

Introduction

- Letters are divided into formal (business, official, application) and informal (personal) letters. Each has a conventional layout and tone — getting the format right earns easy marks in the examination.

Formal letter format

- Writer's address and date at the top right; recipient's address on the left; the salutation (Dear Sir/Madam); the title or subject heading; the body in paragraphs; the subscription (Yours faithfully); and the signature and name. The tone is polite, formal and impersonal; the language is standard English with no slang.

Informal letter format

- Writer's address and date at the top right; a friendly salutation (Dear John, Dear Aunty); the body in paragraphs with the personal news; the subscription (Yours sincerely, Your loving son); signature; no title or heading needed; tone is warm and relaxed.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. List the parts of a formal letter.
2. Differentiate between 'Yours faithfully' and 'Yours sincerely'.
3. In which type of letter do you use a title?
4. State two differences in tone between formal and informal letters.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: NINE

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Paraphrasing

Introduction

- Paraphrasing is restating a sentence or passage in your own words while keeping the original meaning. It is the skill behind summary writing and shows real understanding.

How to paraphrase

- Read and understand the sentence first; replace words with synonyms or rephrase the structure; keep the key facts and the meaning exactly; change the word order where useful but do not change the idea; and never copy the original wording.

Common errors

- Copying the original wording; changing the meaning by replacing words imprecisely; making the paraphrase longer than the original; and mixing the writer's ideas with your own opinions.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define paraphrasing.
2. Paraphrase: 'The examination was postponed because of the heavy rain.'
3. State two rules of good paraphrasing.
4. Why is paraphrasing important in summary writing?

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TEN

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Register & Tone

Introduction

- Register is the variety of language suited to a particular situation; tone is the attitude of the writer (serious, humorous, sympathetic, critical, formal, informal).

Types of register

- **Formal** — official letters, speeches, essays: impersonal, standard, often passive constructions.
- **Informal** — friendly letters, casual talk: conversational, contracted forms, personal.
- **Technical** — the specialist vocabulary of a field: legal, medical, scientific, journalistic.
- A single idea can be expressed in different registers: 'I regret to inform you' (formal) — 'Sorry, but...' (informal).

Tone in passages

- Tone is detected from word choice and sentence patterns: approving, disapproving, ironic, satirical, neutral, sentimental. Questions often ask: 'What is the writer's tone?' — answer with the exact tone word and justify it.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define register and tone.
2. Give one example each of formal, informal and technical register.
3. What tone does 'the so-called leaders' suggest?
4. State two features of formal register.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: ELEVEN

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Summary Skills Workshop

Introduction

- Summary is a shortened version of a passage that keeps the main points in the writer's own words. It tests understanding, precision and economy of language.

The procedure

- Read the passage twice; identify the points that answer the specific question; write each point as one clause in your own words; keep to the required number of points and the word limit; arrange the points in the order they appear; and count your words.

What earns and loses marks

- Earn: accurate points, own words, correct number of points, economy. Lose: lifting sentences from the passage, exceeding the word limit, giving fewer points than asked, and including irrelevant material.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. State three rules of summarising.
2. Why is copying from the passage penalised?
3. What should you do before writing the summary?
4. Summarise in one sentence: 'The pupils arrived early, the hall was ready, and the examination began on time.'

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TWELVE

CLASS: SS1

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Composition Workshop: Application Letters

Introduction

- An application letter is a formal letter written to apply for a job, admission or a place in a school. It combines the formal letter format with persuasive content.

Structure of an application letter

- Your address and date; the recipient's address; salutation (Dear Sir/Madam); the subject heading (APPLICATION FOR THE POST OF...); paragraph 1 — the post and where you saw the advertisement; paragraph 2 — your qualifications, experience and suitability; paragraph 3 — your interest, availability and referee; subscription (Yours faithfully); signature and full name.

Language and accuracy

- Use clear, standard English; be specific (names of institutions, dates, results); be modest but confident; avoid slang, long sentences and irrelevant details; and check spelling, punctuation and layout before submitting.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Write the first two paragraphs of an application for admission to a university.
2. Why is the subject heading important in an application letter?
3. List three things to check before submitting your letter.
4. Which subscription is used when the salutation is Dear Sir/Madam?